

### Answer the questions on “1984” by George Orwell

1. What is “1984” about?

It's about Winston's life and desires that go against the government's ideology.

2. Define the term “totalitarianism”.

A government that tries to control every part of a person's life and mind.

3. What was Orwell trying to do with “1984”?

Giving the reader a view of what life would be if England was a Totalitarian Government

4. Where is “1984” set?

A bad, dangerous and sad copy of London

5. What was the city like?

Depressing, disgusting, scarred by a senseless war.

6. What are people forced to do?

They have to watch the Government programming, News, Exercises, have to attend pep rallies.

7. What are the people not allowed to do?

They are always watched, they can never turn off the TV, can't have friends, can't be in love, can't date or have sex.

8. Why is it difficult to think your own thoughts?

Because the characters' head is constantly filled with propaganda

9. Who are the main characters of “1984”?

Winston Smith, Julia, O'Brien

10. What is the role of the diary written by one of the characters?

It's a place to think about society and how it could be different.

11. What is the turning point of the story?

Julia slips a note to Winston saying that she loves him.

12. What happens at O'Brien's house?

Winston and Julia reveal themselves as rebels to O'Brien

13. What is the main consequence?

Winston and Julia are arrested by the thought police

14. Where is Winston taken afterwards? Why?

To the Ministry of Love to be tortured

15. Why does the government want to exercise thought control?

To have total power over the mind of people like Winston.

16. What happens in Room 101?

People are tortured by using their greatest fears against them.

17. What is the end of the story?

They let Winston and Julia go and they are "broken people".

18. What is the positive message of the book?

The human being can be broken down completely but it's really hard to do what has been done to the characters in the story.

19. Do you think that totalitarianism has completely disappeared? (Motivate your answer)

Totalitarianism can be seen in some countries (North Korea and Iran) but most of the world has started to accept freedom of speech and people's opinions.

Some political parties can still have totalitarian qualities but they can't be compared to what a Totalitarian Government is.

For example North Korea is a totally Totalitarian Regime, people can't think, talk or do what they want; and comparing that to other countries, like America for example, makes it feel like the latter is a heavenly place.

So, no, totalitarianism hasn't completely disappeared and I don't think it ever will, because there'll always be people who search and strive for power and control.